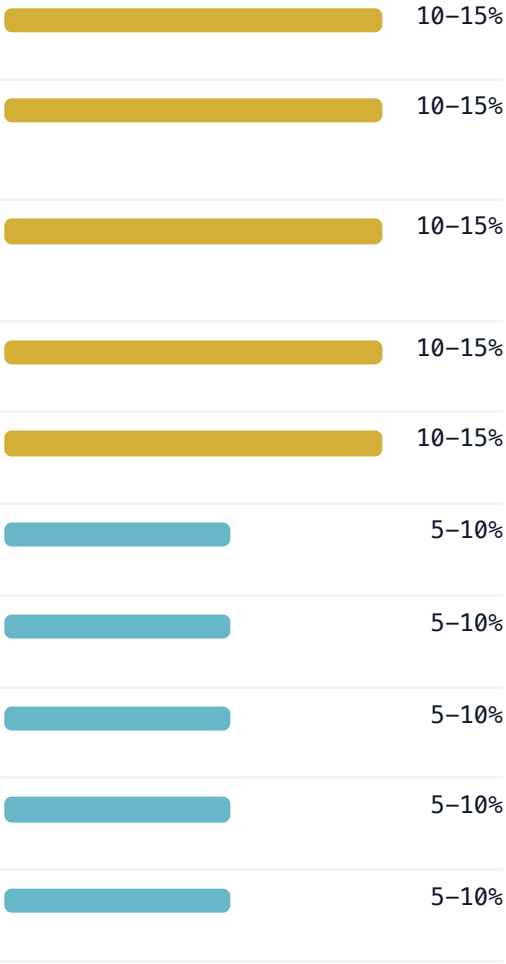
FINANCE IN PRACTICE · FREE GUIDE

CFA® Level II *Exam Map*

Where the marks are, how item sets work, and a 12-week route to exam day.

22	88	2 × 132	300+
item sets (a case plus four questions)	multiple-choice questions	minutes, two sessions	study hours reported by passing candidates

Where the marks are, and what to master



Ethical and Professional Standards Code and Standards applied to full case vignettes	10–15%
Equities Dividend discount · free cash flow (FCFF, FCFE) · residual income · multiples · private companies	10–15%
Financial Statement Analysis Intercorporate investments · pensions and share-based pay · multinationals · earnings quality	10–15%
Fixed Income Term structure · binomial trees · bonds with embedded options · credit models · CDS	10–15%
Portfolio Construction Multifactor models · VaR and risk measures · backtesting and simulation	10–15%
Quantitative Methods Multiple regression and its diagnostics · time series · machine learning	5–10%
Economics Exchange-rate parity conditions · economic growth	5–10%
Corporate Finance Dividends and buybacks · cost of capital · ESG · restructuring	5–10%
Derivatives Pricing forwards, futures and swaps · binomial and Black–Scholes–Merton · Greeks	5–10%
Alternative Investments Real estate and REITs · private capital · commodities	5–10%

High priority: the heaviest topics. Weights: CFA Institute 2027 topic outline.

> **The five gold topics are 50–75% of the exam.** Level II is about applying models to a case. Equity and fixed income valuation, FSA and ethics carry the result.

Exam windows: Level II runs in May, August and November. Check dates and fees at cfainstitute.org.

STRATEGY

A 12-week route that follows how topics build on each other

About 25 hours a week. Studying 15 hours a week? Stretch the same order over 20 weeks.

Wk 1	**Quantitative Methods + Economics**	Regression output and currency parity: read them, don't derive them.
Wk 2–3	**Financial Statement Analysis**	Intercorporate investments, multinationals, earnings quality.
Wk 4	**Corporate Finance**	Capital structure, dividends, ESG and restructuring.
Wk 5–6	**Equities**	DCF, residual income and multiples. Heaviest valuation block.
Wk 7–8	**Fixed Income**	Term structure, arbitrage-free trees, credit analysis.
Wk 9	**Derivatives + Alternative Investments**	Pricing forwards, swaps and options; real estate and private capital.
Wk 10–11	**Portfolio Construction + Ethics**	Ethics last, so it is fresh on exam day.
Wk 12	**Mock exams + review**	Full item-set mocks under time. Fix the error pattern.

How to study it

- **Practise item sets, not single questions.** Level II rewards reading a case fast; drill full vignettes from week one.
- **Start valuation early.** Equity, fixed income and FSA build on each other and take the longest.
- **Keep an error log.** Write why each wrong answer was wrong; retake those questions until you get them right twice.
- **Last month is mocks.** Full item-set mocks under time show your real pace.

Exam-day rules worth knowing

- **About 3 minutes per question.** Each item set should take about 12 minutes.
- **Read the questions before the case.** Then read the vignette knowing what to look for.
- **Cases include data you don't need.** Spotting the right number is half the question.
- **No penalty for wrong answers.** Never leave a question blank.

PRACTISE WITH US

Your prep keeps going between sessions

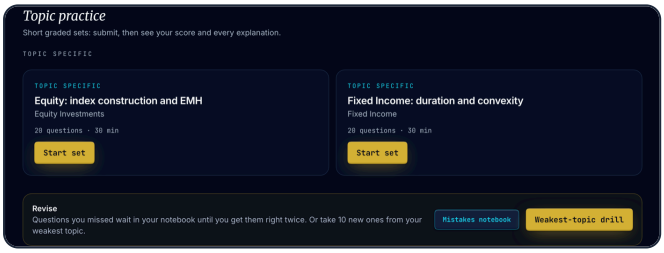
Our students sit timed mocks and topic exams on a screen like exam day's, compare every result with the last one, and drill their weakest topic. financeinpractice.me/#portal



Exam-day screen. Clock, question map, flags, crossing out and notes.



Results compared. Every mock and every topic against your last attempt.



Topic exams and a weakest-topic drill. Missed questions wait in a notebook until you get them right twice.

Shown: a Level I student, sample data.

Free Question Bank

Original exam-style Level II questions on our website, each with the worked solution, why the wrong answers are wrong and the exam trap.

financeinpractice.me/cfa/questions?level=2

Want this plan built around your exam date?

Book a free 30-minute diagnostic session. We find your weak topics and map your route to exam day. At your home in Abu Dhabi or live online.

financeinpractice.me/#book · WhatsApp +971 58 807 0565

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